



SYMBIOSIS INTERNATIONAL (DEEMED UNIVERSITY)

(Established under section 3 of the UGC Act, 1956)
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Seat No.							
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Institute:

(0203) SYMBIOSIS CENTRE FOR MANAGEMENT AND HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT,
PUNE

Programme:

(020344) MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT AND
MANAGEMENT)

Batch:

2024-26

Semester:

I

Course:

Organizational Behaviour

Course Code:

0203440112

Date: 15/03/2025

Thursday

Maximum Marks: 40

Time: 09:30 - 11:00

NOTE : DO NOT WRITE ANYTHING ON THE QUESTION PAPER

Instructions:

- 1) All questions are compulsory.

1. Case Scenario

Global Solutions, a multinational consulting firm, was undergoing a restructuring process. As part of the changes, the company merged two departments with very different work cultures. One department, based in the US, followed a formal, hierarchical structure with clear communication protocols. The other department, based in Europe, operated in a flat, flexible, and informal environment.

After the merger, conflicts began to surface. The US team felt that the European team lacked discipline and didn't follow proper channels for decision-making. On the other hand, the European team felt constrained by the US team's rigid structure and believed it stifled creativity and innovation. The ongoing conflict began to affect productivity, communication, and overall team morale.

To resolve the situation, the HR department introduced a conflict management strategy focused on building understanding between the two teams. They facilitated open dialogues where employees from both sides could share their concerns and perspectives. A third-party mediator was brought in to help guide the conversations and ensure both teams were heard. The company then developed new communication protocols that allowed flexibility for informal interactions but ensured that key decisions followed a formal approval process. Additionally, cross-cultural training workshops were introduced to foster greater respect for the different work styles.

Outcome:

Within three months, productivity improved, and team members reported better communication and collaboration. Employees from both teams began to adapt to the new norms and recognized the strengths of the other department's work style. The conflict was largely resolved, and the teams successfully integrated.

Question 1:

Analyze the conflict management approach used by Global Solutions. What were the key elements that helped resolve the conflict? How could the company prevent similar conflicts from arising in future mergers? **(CO2) (10 marks)**

Q.2 Explain the following (CO 1)

- a) Intrinsic and extrinsic motivation **(5 Marks)**
- b) Social Learning Theory **(5 Marks)**

Q.3 'Integrative bargaining is a negotiation strategy that aims to create a win-win situation for all parties involved, whereas Distributive bargaining is a negotiation strategy that involves dividing a fixed amount of resources, often referred to as a "fixed pie". Analyze the statements and demonstrate how integrative bargaining is different from distributive bargaining with appropriate examples.

(CO 1) (10 marks)

Q.4 How do specific personality traits, such as those identified in the Big Five model, influence workplace behavior and team dynamics?

(CO 3) (10 marks)
